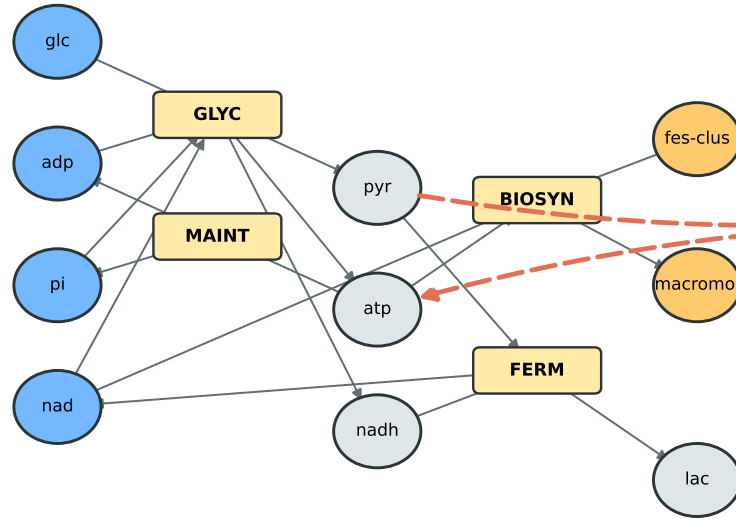
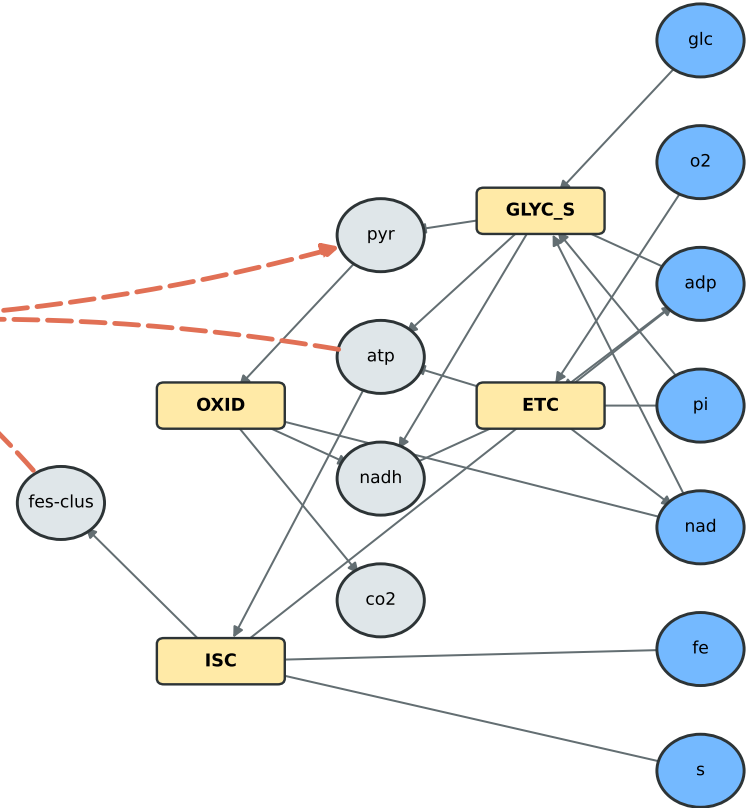


Toy endosymbiosis model: host alone = 1 EPM (8 sp.), symbiont alone = 1 EPM (12 sp.), merged = 1 EPM (22 sp., 100% hybrid) -- interface unlocks 2 species neither partner reaches alone

HOST (glycolysis + fermentation)



SYMBIONT (oxidative phosphorylation + Fe-S biogenesis)



● food species
 ● internal species
 ● reachable ONLY once merged
 - - - interface (transport) reaction